Humanizing Teacher Education: Developing Equity Mindsets Towards Equity Behaviors Through Facilitated Learning Communities

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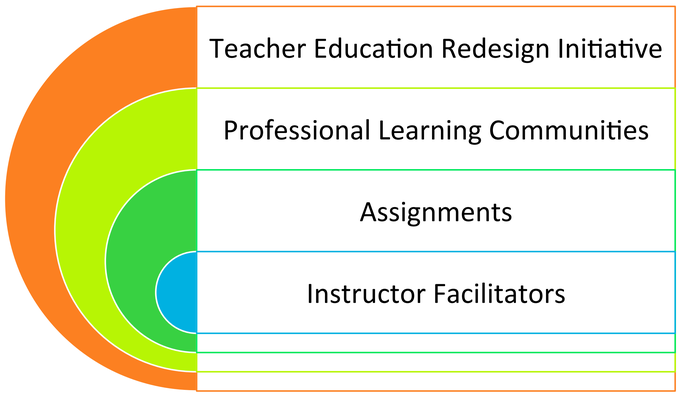
Curriculum and Instruction
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Background

Guiding Questions

- How do we humanize spaces where concepts of scholarship and professionalism are developed?
- How do we provide opportunities for community engagement in spaces where professional identity develops?
- What is the role of the instructor in the development of engaged scholars and professionals?

Context



Terms and Scholarship

Humanizing dispositions: ways of thinking and being in diverse contexts. Recent work has called on teacher preparation programs to design explicit strategies that develop teacher candidates' humanizing dispositions (Freire; Bartolome; Franquiz & Salazar; Salazar, Lowenstein, & Brill, 2010; Salazar, 2013).

Professional identity: authentic and contextualized knowledge of self in practice (Hollins, 2011)

Culturally relevant pedagogy: teaching that is sensitive and responsive to diverse student characteristics and educational needs (Ladson-Billings, 1992; Delpit, 1995; Gay, 2000; Brown-Jeffy, 2011)

[Community-]engaged scholarship and pedagogy: academic efforts that reflexively engage with and for the community (hooks, 1994; Barker, 2004; Van de Ven, 2007)



Findings and Implications

Humanizing Learning Spaces

- Provide tasks that bridge the academic, personal, and professional
- Build learning communities that are compassionate and challenging

Community Engagement

- Link learning tasks to the local community
- Develop partnerships with community stakeholders
- Develop explicit expectations for professional interaction in community contexts

Role of the Instructor

- The instructor is a "nurturing disruptor"
- Provides timely questions, critiques, feedback, and supports that prompt student integration of theory, practice, and research
- May require prolonged and trusting relationship between instructor and student
- Remain flexible and model engaged scholarship and pedagogy

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